

you the time and hassle of making phone calls to each individual complex to get information. Try to avoid using an apartment-finder service that costs money. Some of them charge an entire month's rent.



Two of the larger online apartment-finder services are Apartments.com (www.apartments.com) and ApartmentGuide.com (www.apartmentguide.com). Both have millions of listings nationwide, many with photos and floor plans, plus helpful articles on moving and settling in.

The better services will have a real estate agent contact you when you fill out an online form indicating your housing requirements. Some will even have your utilities hooked up for you without charge once you find an apartment you want.